

Vocabulary & Context Clues

Name:

Date:

ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY10: Use knowledge of base words, prefixes and suffixes to read and comprehend new multimorphemic words.

Learning Intention: I am learning to work out the meaning of new words using clues in the sentence around them.**Key Idea:** A **context clue** is information in a sentence that helps you guess what a tricky word means, even if you've never seen it before.**Warm-Up:** Read this sentence: "The enormous elephant was bigger than a truck." What do you think "enormous" means?

A. Guess the Meaning

Use context clues to guess the meaning of the bold word.

1. The **ancient** castle was built over 500 years ago.

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2. She felt **miserable** after losing her favourite toy.

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B. Prefixes

Add the prefix "un" or "re" to change the meaning. Write the new word.

1. happy → ____

2. write → ____

3. kind → ____

C. Suffixes

Add the suffix "ful" or "less" to complete each word.

1. care____ (means without care)

2. help____ (means full of help)

D. Word Match

Draw a line to match each word to its meaning.

gigantic tiny furious

very small very angry very big

Answer Guide & Extension Activities

Suggested Answers – A & B

A. 1. Ancient means very old. 2. Miserable means very sad or unhappy.

B. 1. unhappy 2. rewrite 3. unkind

Suggested Answers – C & D

C. 1. careless 2. helpful

D. gigantic – very big, tiny – very small, furious – very angry

High Five Stars – Self Assessment

★ I used context clues

★ I added prefixes correctly

★ I added suffixes correctly

★ I matched words to meanings

Extension Activity

Find one new tricky word in a book you are reading. Write the sentence it appears in and guess its meaning using context clues.

Parent/Teacher Tip

When your child asks what a word means during reading, try asking 'What do you think it means?' first before explaining, to build their guessing skills.

Reflection

What clue helped you the most when guessing a tricky word's meaning today?

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